Heewon Hwang

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Education

Yonsei University Mar 2025 – Present
M.S./Ph.D. in Finance (Integrated Program) (GPA: 4.05/4.30) *Seoul, Republic of Korea*

Yonsei University Mar 2020 – Feb 2025
B.B.A. in Business Administration, Advanced Concentration in CS/AI (GPA: 4.09/4.30) *Seoul, Republic of Korea*
**Leave of absence for military service: Mar 2021 – Dec 2021*

American International School Chennai Jan 2011 – May 2019
International Baccalaureate: 44/45, Student Council President *Chennai, India*

Research Interests

Asset Pricing, Institutional Investors, Investor Demand

Working Paper

"Do ETFs Connect Stocks?"
with Prof. Jun Kyung Auh

- We examine whether ETFs contribute to stock return comovement by transmitting demand shocks across their underlying holdings. Specifically, stock-level shocks may induce performance-chasing ETF demand, which propagates to co-held securities through basket-level arbitrage. To quantify these linkages, we construct a time-varying measure of stock connectedness combining stocks' portfolio weights within ETFs (shock exposure) and ETFs' ownership shares in underlying securities (demand transmission). We find that ETF-based connectedness strongly predicts subsequent pairwise return correlations, with evidence from Russell index reconstitution further supporting the role of ETF-induced demand transmission.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Yonsei University School of Business Feb 2024 – Present
Advisor: Prof. Jun Kyung Auh

- Set up and maintained Yonsei's XRP node as part of the University Blockchain Research Initiative (UBRI).
- Contributed to the lab's research infrastructure, building security identifier cross-reference module and renovating reproducible Python research environments using `uv`.
- Supported research on Korean Equity Linked Securities (ELS) by preprocessing data on 300,000+ products via the Korea Securities Depository API and extracting prospectus data from DART.
- Facilitated municipal-bond research on natural-disaster risk collecting Bloomberg data.

Realized Semibetas in the Korean Market, Honors Thesis Mar 2024 – Jun 2024
Advisor: Prof. Jaehoon Hahn

- Conducted an extension study of Bollerslev et al. (2022) semibeta asset pricing model on the Korean stock market including KOSPI, KOSDAQ, and the overall market.
- Evaluated the model's robustness for more recent market movements and financial crises, such as COVID-19 and the 2022 market decline.

Work Experience

MD STAAGE, *Sleep Technology* Jan 2025 – Present
Research Assistant

- Developed and evaluated machine-learning models for real-time Obstructive Sleep Apnea (OSA) prediction using clinical sleep data from over 1,000+ patients, combining wearable-compatible physiological signals and patient characteristics.
- Designed a lightweight on-device OSA detection model for resource-constrained oral devices using real-time sound level (dB) and body-position signals from 300+ patients.

Levit (Alwayz), *E-commerce* Jul 2022 – Aug 2022

Marketing Intern

- Pioneered a viral item discovery methodology leveraging NAVER Datalab (Korean equivalent of Google Trends) shopping search data to identify trending products appropriate for in-app promotions.
- Conducted user interviews to gather insight on influential online communities and sources of virality among stay-at-home moms.

Republic of Korea Army Mar 2021 – Dec 2021

Administrative Specialist, 9th Ammunition Depot

- Performed inventory management tasks for all ammunition storage units using the Defense Logistics Integrated Information System and inventory simulator.

Teaching Experience

Yonsei University School of Business

- TA, Money and Banking (Undergraduate), Prof. Won-chang Choi — Fall 2025 – Fall 2026
- TA, Corporate Finance (Undergraduate), Prof. Jun Kyung Auh — Spring 2026 – Fall 2026
- TA, Business Economics for Executives (MBA), Prof. Jun Kyung Auh — Spring 2026
- Mentor, Mentor–Mentee Program for International Undergraduate Students — Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

Honors and Awards

Doctoral Excellence Scholarship	Jun 2026 – Present
UBRI Scholarship	Jan 2025 – Present
Yonsei AI Concentration Major Scholarship	Dec 2024, Jul 2024, Jul 2023
Yonsei Merit-based Scholarship	Aug 2024, Feb 2024, Jan 2023, Feb 2022
Honors, Yonsei University	Aug 2024, Feb 2021
Yonsei Business School Scholarship for Outstanding Student	Oct 2022
High Honors, Yonsei University	Aug 2022

Selected Coursework **for Graduate-level Courses*

Mathematics & Statistics: Real Analysis, Econometrics*, Linear Algebra, Time Series Analysis, Mathematical Statistics, Graphs and Complex Networks*
Finance & Economics: Asset Pricing*, Microeconomics I*, Microeconomics II*, Empirical Finance*, Introductory Finance Theory*, Corporate Finance Theory*, Futures and Options*, Macroeconomics
Computer Science & AI: Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming, SW Programming, IoT and Robotics, Computer Algorithms for AI Applications, AI-Assisted Financial Engineering

Skills

Programming: Python, R, Stata, LaTeX, HTML/CSS
Languages: Korean (Native), English (Fluent; GRE Verbal 166/170, TOEFL 118/120), Spanish (Intermediate; IB Spanish SL 7/7)
Hobbies: Basketball, Sketching

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